



Butt vs face recognition

Researchers found out that chimpanzees can recognise each other's butts the way human recognises faces. <http://digit.in/buttRecgnse>



Fitbit buys Pebble

Health tech company Fitbit officially announces that they are buying smartwatch maker Pebble. <http://digit.in/fitbitPble>

CHAPTER 4 - INTERNET - THE E-BOOK ARRIVES

With the arrival of the internet in the early 1990s, the potential of e-books was recognized. Tim Berners-Lee's original vision with the internet was to facilitate the sharing of information freely and this began to take shape immediately as books being shared online. In 1993, Bibliobytes, the first online store for ebooks launched. Also John Mark Ockerbloom, who was then a Carnegie Mellon University student, launched Online Books Page as "a website that facilitates access to books that are freely readable over the Internet."

BACKSTORY 3 - EBOOK FORMATS

Meanwhile, the world of ebooks was facing an issue that echoes across any new digital media and technology development - lack of standardisation. As ebooks were growing with the internet, major software companies were each pushing their own specific formats. Adobe released its Portable Document Format (PDF) in 1993. Due to features like platform independence, DRM support, semantic structure, PDF did gain its fair share of popularity over just using XML, which was the practice at the time. However, one of its advantages was also its biggest problem - it displayed documents as they would be printed, irrespective of device screen size.

BACKSTORY 2 - E-INK

The concept behind electronic paper displays existed since the 1970s. But it took more than 20 years for it to come into any kind of realisation. In the year 1995, physicist Joseph Jacobson and a few undergrads at the MIT media lab were trying to create a multi-page electronic book where content would change at the push of a button. While their initial approach was to manipulate half-black and half-white spheres using electric charge, an accidental creation of all-white spheres combined with failures of the original idea led them to the discovery of e-ink. They put the all-white and black spheres into a microcapsule with dark dye and that's what went on to become the E-ink which they patented the same year. This was obviously improved upon in years to come.

In the year 2019, works like Felix Salten's "Bambi" and Kahlil Gibran's "The Prophet" along with more will enter the public domain. Why is 2019 special? Check out the copyright extensions enforced by the US government over the last century.

CHAPTER 5 - EREADERS ARRIVE

Thanks to improving battery capacity, ebook readers became a possibility around the late 1990s. The Rocket eBook was released in 1998. With an LCD screen, it could store up to 10 ebooks and sold upto 20,000 units till 1999. It had its own proprietary format as the Rocket eBook format.

BACKSTORY 3 - PART 2

The PDF format didn't work for mobile devices. As the tech world was increasingly moving towards smaller devices, including smaller portable e-readers, there was the need for a flexible format. The first move towards this was the Mobipocket ebook file format created by Mobipocket.com. This format's extensions are .mobi and .prc. It could take more complex content as compared to existing standards. For example, readers can add their own pages, freehand drawings, etc